11.6 Diabetic and Venous Leg Ulcers*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The wound on my leg has been open for months." **Objective** • Venous ulcer above the inner ankle • Edema • Hemosiderin staining	**ACTUAL** Impaired tissue integrity related to venous insufficiency as evidenced by a chronic open ulcer.	• Ulcer smaller within 4 weeks.	• Measure the ulcer weekly. • Measure the ABPI before compression, as ordered. • Apply compression bandaging as prescribed. • Teach leg elevation.	• Achieved as the ulcer gets smaller.
Subjective • "The bandages are uncomfortable." **Objective** • Reluctant to wear compression • Takes the bandages off at night	**ACTUAL** Ineffective health self-management related to discomfort of compression therapy as evidenced by removal of bandages.	• Keeps compression on as prescribed.	• Explain how compression helps healing. • Make sure bandages are applied correctly and comfortably. • Teach walking and ankle exercises.	• Outcome reached when compression is kept on.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Long-standing open wound	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: chronic open wound.	• Ulcer free of infection.	• Watch for more pain, odor, exudate or spreading redness. • Take a swab if infection is suspected.	• Considered met if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [116]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.